Renderings: the Sumerian Flood Story (project glossary)

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Words, names and formulas used in this text and not (or not yet) in the shared `../renderings.md`. The shared file binds; this one extends it. Lemmas are ePSD2 citation forms `cf[gw]` (ORACC Q000357). Echo tags per guidelines §6.4.

1. Names

Sumerian	Hebrew (first occurrence vocalized)	Lines	Notes
Ziusudra zi-ud-su₃-ra₂	זִיּוּסוּדְרָה	C 11, 18; D 7, 9; E 4, 6, 9	Shared. Name = "life of distant days"; Akk. Ūta-napišti "he found life" may be a reinterpretation. Poebel 1914 read "Ziugiddu".
An	אַן	A 11, C 9–10, C 25, E 2, 5, 6	Shared. Distinguish from an "heaven" (שָׁמַיִם).
Enlil	אֶנְלִיל	A 11, C 9–10, C 25, E 2, 5, 6; Ur r 6′, 9′	Shared.
Enki	אֶנְקִי	A 11, C 8–9	Shared.
Nudimmud	נוּדִימּוּד	B 11	Epithet-name of Enki ("the one who fashions/begets").
Ninḫursaĝa	נִין־חֻרְסַגָּה	A 11, C 9	Shared.
Nintur	נִינְתּוּר	A 3, C 6	Sumerian form of Nintu (shared נִינְתּוּ).
Inana	אִינַנָּה	C 7	Not Ištar/אִשְׁתַּר in a Sumerian text.
Utu	אוּתּוּ	B 14, D 6, 8, 10; E 11	Shared. The sun-god; {d}utu e₃ = sunrise.
Pabilsaĝ	פַּבִּילְסַג	B 13	The scribe wrote pa-bil₂-«ḫur»-saĝ.
Sud	סוּד	B 15	Goddess of Šuruppag (later identified with Ninlil). First occurrence: (הָאֵלָה) סוּד to prevent reading "secret".
nu-gig	הַגְּבִירָה	B 12	"High-status woman", epithet of Inana.
Šakkan	שַׁכַּן	Ur o 8′	God of wild animals / the steppe.
Ki-ur	קִי־אוּר	C 17	Enlil's temple court in Nippur.
Eridug, Bad-tibira, Larag, Zimbir, Šuruppag	אֶרִידוּ, בַּד־טִיבִּירָה, לָרַךְ, סִיפַּר, שׁוּרוּפַּךְ	B 11–15; Ur r 7′	Shared (Akkadian forms). The Sumerian form is given in the note at first occurrence.

Sumerian	Hebrew (first occurrence vocalized)	Lines	Notes
Dilmun	דִּלְמוּן	E 11	Shared. Bahrain and the Gulf coast; a land "beyond the sea".

2. Recurring words

Sumerian (ePSD2)	Hebrew	Rejected	Reason	Lines	Tag
amaru[flood]	מַבּוּל	—	Shared.	C 3, 22; D 2, 4	[equivalent]
ma[ship] ({ĝiš}ma₂)	סְפִינָה	תֵּבָה	Shared. ma₂ gur₄-gur₄ "the thick/massive boat" → הַסְּפִינָה הָעֲנָקִית.	D 5, 7, 8	[divergence]
ur[drag] (ur₃)	שָׁטַף	סָחַף, הֵצִיף	"Drag, sweep, raze". Shared §3a: שָׁטַף (not סחף); no Genesis word.	C 22; D 2, 4	—
namlulu[humanity]	הָאֱנוֹשׁוּת	הָאָדָם	= *awīlūtu*.	A 2; C 4, 23; E 10; Ur	—
uŋ[people]	הָאֲנָשִׁים	הָעָם	= *nišū*.	A 4; C 7	—
saŋ giggig	שְׁחוֹרֵי הָרֹאשׁ	—	Standard epithet of mankind.	A 12	—
niŋgilim[rodent]	הַיְצוּרִים הַקְּטַנִּים	שֶׁרֶץ, רֶמֶשׂ, חַיּוֹת	Small creatures; the Genesis words would pre-empt.	A 13; E 3, 10	[equivalent] with שֶׁרֶץ/רֶמֶשׂ
mašanše[animals]	הַמִּקְנֶה	בְּהֵמָה	Lit. "goats-and-donkeys" = livestock, animals.	A 14	[equivalent]
niŋurlimmu[creature]	הַהוֹלְכִים עַל אַרְבַּע	—	"Four-legged"; cf. Lev 11:20 wording, not Genesis.	A 14	—
eden[steppe]	עֲרָבָה	עֵדֶן	Echo control (etymology note).	A 14; Ur o 2′ (an-eden: הָעֲרָבָה הָעֶלְיוֹנָה)	[cognate?]

Sumerian (ePSD2)	Hebrew	Rejected	Reason	Lines	Tag
dim[create]	עִצֵּב	יָצַר, עָשָׂה, בָּרָא	"Fashion, shape"; the neutral Hebrew verb.	A 12; C 12	[equivalent] with יָצַר
niŋdimdima[creature]	יְצוּרִים (יְצוּרֵי)	בְּרוּאִים	Ordinary noun; root יצר noted.	A 3	—
halam[forsake]	אָבַד (פִּעֵל: אִבֵּד; noun אָבְדָן)	הִשְׁמִיד, כִּלָּה	"Destroy, make disappear" (Akk. *ḫalāqu* D); the same root in A 2 and C 23.	A 2; C 23	—
numun[seed]	זֶרַע	—	Meaning first; = Akk. *zēru*.	C 23; E 10	[equivalent]
zi[life]	חַיִּים	נֶפֶשׁ	In oath (zi an-na) and in zi da-ri₂.	E 1, 2, 8	—
til[live] (til₃)	חַיִּים (noun, E 7); יָשַׁב/הוֹשִׁיב (E 11 causative, E 12)	—	til₃ = "live, dwell".	E 7, 11, 12	—
dari[eternal]	נָצַח (zi da-ri₂ = חַיֵּי נָצַח)	עוֹלָם	Avoid pre-empting Gen 3:22.	E 8	[equivalent]
diŋir[deity] + -giₙ	כָּאֵל	כֵּאלֹהִים	Shared *ilu* = אֵל.	E 7, 8	—
kab dug₄-ga	הַחֻלָּקוֹת הַמְּדוּדוֹת?	—	See project.md Decisions §2. Identical in all four lines.	B 10, 16; C 22; D 2	—
ŋarza[rites]	הַטְּקָסִים	—		A 9; B 8	—
me[Being] + mah	הַ־מֶּה הַנִּשְׂגָּבִים	חֻקִּים	The divine powers/ordinances; kept transliterated (2026-10-21).	A 9; B 8	—

Sumerian (ePSD2)	Hebrew	Rejected	Reason	Lines	Tag
mah[great]	נִשְׂגָּב	נַעֲלֶה, גָּדוֹל	Used for men mah too.	A 9; B 7, 8	—
kug[pure]	טָהוֹר	קָדוֹשׁ	ki kug-ga = בִּמְקוֹמוֹת טְהוֹרִים; kug {d}inana = אִינַנָּה הַטְּהוֹרָה.	A 6, 7; B 9; C 7	—
šeg[brick] + šub	לְבֵנִים + הִנִּיחַ	—	"Lay the bricks".	A 6; B 9	[equivalent] with 11:3
ki[place]	מָקוֹם; אֶרֶץ (in an ki); אֲדָמָה (irrigated ground, A 10)	—	The annotated file names the Sumerian behind each.	passim	—
kalam[land]	הָאָרֶץ	—	"The Land" (Sumer) = *mātu*.	B 5; D 4	—
an[sky]	שָׁמַיִם	—	an ki = שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ.	B 6, 7; C 1, 10, 16; D 6; E 1, 2	[equivalent] with 1:1 pair
namlugal[kingship]	מַלְכוּת	מְלוּכָה		B 6, 7; C 26	—
lugal[king]	מֶלֶךְ	—	Z. lugal-am₃ = זִיאוּסוּדְרָה, הַמֶּלֶךְ in every occurrence.	C 11; D 9, 11; E 4, 9	—
šul[youth]	הָעֶלֶם	גִּבּוֹר	Utu's epithet.	B 14; D 8	—
izzida[side-wall]	קִיר הַצַּד	גֶּדֶר	Addressed in the warning.	C 19, 20	[divergence] with 6:13
egar[wall] (e₂-ĝar₈)	קִיר	—	= Akk. *igāru* (loan from Sumerian).	C 17	—
inim[word]	דָּבָר	—	= *amātu* (shared).	C 13, 15, 20, 24, 25	—

Sumerian (ePSD2)	Hebrew	Rejected	Reason	Lines	Tag
na de₅ (noun)	עֵצָה	הוֹרָאָה, מוּסָר	"Instruction, advice" (cf. the title of the Instructions of Šuruppag).	C 21	—
ŋizzal[ear] ak	הִקְשִׁיב	—	"Pay attention".	C 21	—
ŋeš tuku	שָׁמַע	—	"Hear, listen".	C 18	—
mu pad₃	נִשְׁבַּע בְּשֵׁם	—	"Invoke the name", i.e. swear. zi an-na … pad₃ = נִשְׁבַּע בְּחַיֵּי.	C 10, 16; E 1, 2	—
ditila[case]	דִּין חָלוּט	—	"Completed (closed) lawsuit".	C 24	—
puhrum[assembly]	אֲסֵפָה	עֵדָה	Shared *puḫru*. A loanword from Akkadian in the Sumerian text.	C 24	—
nam[fate] + tar	גּוֹרָל + נִגְזַר	—		C 23	—
imhul[wind]	רוּחַ רָעָה, pl. רוּחוֹת רָעוֹת	סְעָרָה	Akk. *imḫullu* "evil wind".	D 1, 5	—
sisig[breeze]	סְעָרָה	—	"Wind, gale".	D 1	—
abbur (ab-BUR₂) + burud	חֲרַךְ + קָדַח	חַלּוֹן, צֹהַר	An opening bored through; Song 2:9 הַחֲרַכִּים.	D 7	[equivalent] with צֹהַר/חַלּוֹן
ŋešnu[light]	אוֹר	קֶרֶן		D 8	—
kiri ki sub + gub	הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה, אַפּוֹ אַרְצָה	—	"Rub the nose on the ground".	D 10; E 5	—
gaz[kill]	שָׁחַט	זָבַח	The verb is "kill"; the sacrificial context is clear.	D 11	—
šar[numerous]	הִרְבָּה	—	"Make numerous" (offer many).	D 11	—

Sumerian (ePSD2)	Hebrew	Rejected	Reason	Lines	Tag
kurbal[country]	אֶרֶץ הַמַּעֲבָר	—	"Land across (the sea)".	E 11	—
ud-ba, ud-bi-a	בְּעֵת הַהִיא	בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם		C 6, 11; E 9; Ur o 3′, 11′	[equivalent] with 6:4
nesaŋ[offering]	רֵאשִׁית	—	"First-fruit offering" → "the first". רֵאשִׁית carries both senses.	B 11	[equivalent] with 10:10
n-kam-ma(-še₃)	הַשְּׁנִיָּה, הַשְּׁלִישִׁית …	—	Ordinals, feminine (עִיר).	B 12–15; Ur r 2′–4′	—

3. Formulas

Sumerian	Hebrew	Lines
ŋarza me mah šu mi-ni-ib-šu-du₇	אֶת הַטְּקָסִים וְאֶת הַ־מֶּה הַנִּשְׂגָּבִים הִשְׁלִים	A 9 = B 8
an {d}en-lil₂ {d}en-ki {d}nin-hur-saŋ-ŋa₂-ke₄	אַן, אֶנְלִיל, אֶנְקִי וְנִין־חֻרְסַגָּה	A 11 = C 9
zi-ud-su₃-ra₂ lugal-am₃	זִיוּסוּדְרָה, הַמֶּלֶךְ	D 9 = E 4; with ud-ba: C 11, E 9
igi X-še₃ giri₁₇ ki su-ub ba-gub	הִשְׁתַּחֲוָה, אַפּוֹ אַרְצָה — X לִפְנֵי	D 10, E 5
mu-bi ba-an-sa₄ kab dug₄-ga ba-hal-hal-la	שְׁמָן קָרָא, וְהַחֲלָקוֹת (אֶת) הַמְּדוּדוֹת? חֻלְּקוּ	B 10, B 16
a-ma-ru ugu kab dug₄-ga … ur₃	הַמַּבּוּל … עַל הַחֲלָקוֹת הַמְּדוּדוֹת? שָׁטַף …	C 22, D 2
zi an-na zi ki-a i₃-pad₃-de₃-(en-)ze₂-en	בְּחַיֵּי הַשָּׁמַיִם, בְּחַיֵּי הָאָרֶץ — תִּשְׁבָּעוּ	E 1, E 2
X-kam-ma(-še₃) <city> <god>-ra mi-ni-in-šum₂	הַ<ordinal>, <city>, נָתַן לְ<god>	B 11–15

2026-10-21 harmonization (the lead's cross-corpus decisions): *me* = הַ־מָה (always vocalized), *me maḫ* = הַ־מָה הַנִּשְׂגָּבִים, replacing הַכֹּחוֹת הַנִּשְׂגָּבִים in A 9 = B 8 (rows above fixed). Inana = אִינַנָּה always vocalized (already so). *nam-šub* = קֶסֶם: the apparatus now calls Enmerkar 136–140 "קסם נודימוד" (was "לחש").